

Eleonora Minaeva

CONTACT INFORMATION	<i>Mobile:</i> +39 351 519 2429 <i>Web-page:</i> eleonora-minaeva.com <i>Email:</i> eleonora.minaeva@eui.eu	
RESEARCH INTERESTS	Subnational Politics and Decentralization; Electoral Institutions and Accountability; Political Economy of Governance; Contentious Politics; Post-Soviet and Eurasian Politics.	
EDUCATION	European University Institute , Florence, Italy	
	Ph.D. in Political Science	2022–present
	Department of Political and Social Sciences	
	• Thesis: <i>Political (De)Centralization Under Authoritarianism</i>	
	European University at St.Petersburg , St. Petersburg, Russia	
	Master of Political Science, Department of Political Science	2018–2020
	• Thesis: <i>Factors of Electoral Mobilization at the Local Level in Russia: 2016–2018</i>	
	• GPA: 3.95	
	Perm State University , Perm, Russia	
	Master of International Relationships, Department of Political Science	2017–2019
	• Thesis: <i>The Influence of European Urban Practices on Coalition Interactions in the Largest Russian Cities</i>	
	• GPA: 4.0	
	Bachelor of Political Science, Department of Political Science	2013–2017
	• Thesis: <i>Ethnic Territorial Autonomies: The Problem of Political Space Segmentation</i>	
	• GPA: 3.96	
ACADEMIC POSITIONS	European University Institute , Florence, Italy	
	PhD Researcher, Department of Political and Social Sciences	2022–present
	Center for Comparative History and Political Studies , Russia	
	Research Fellow	September 2020–June 2022
	Institute for European, Russian and Eurasian Studies (IERES) , George Washington University, Washington DC, USA	
	Visiting Scholar	January 2025–May 2025
PUBLICATIONS	[1] Serebrennikov D., Minaeva E., Ross S. (2026) Surveillance as Governance: Policing Effectiveness and Political Control in the Moscow AI Experiment. <i>Forthcoming in Russian Politics</i> .	
	[2] Kostelka F., Alberdi M., Bradley M., Fiselier T., Jabbour A., Mansour N., Minaeva E., Porciuleanu S., Rafailova D. (2026) Mass Attitudes towards Russia's Aggression against Ukraine: Tentative Support for Top-Down Opinion Formation <i>Forthcoming in European Journal of Political Research</i> .	

- [3] Semenov A., Minaeva E. (2024) [Mobilizational Momentum and Electoral Results of "Party in Power"](#). *Politeia*, Vol. 1 (112), 77-97. DOI: 10.30570/2078-5089-2024-112-1-77-97. *(in Russian)*
- [4] Minaeva E., Rumiantseva A., Zavadskaya M. (2023) [From local elections to appointments: How has municipal reform changed vote delivery in Russian municipalities?](#) *Electoral Studies*, Vol. 85, DOI:10.1016/j.electstud.2023.102657.
- [5] Minaeva E. (2023) Policy Activism in Urban Governance: The Case of Master Plan Development in Perm. in Jeremy Morris, Andrei Semenov and Regina Smyth (Ed.) *Varieties of Russian Activism: State-Society Contestation in Everyday Life*. Bloomington: Indiana University Press.
- [6] Minaeva E. (2022) Strategies for the Preservation and Cancellation of the Direct Election of Municipal Heads in Russia. *Universe of Russia. Sociology. Ethnology*, Vol. 31, Issue 2: 97-117. *(in Russian)*
- [7] Minaeva E., Panov P. (2021) Dense Networks, Ethnic Minorities, and Electoral Mobilization in Contemporary Russia. *Problems of Post-Communism*, DOI:10.1080/10758216.2021.1974885.
- [8] Bederson V, Zhelnina A, Zaporozhets O, Minaeva E, Semenov A, Tykanova E, Khokhlova A, Chernysheva A, Shevtsova I. (2021). *Cities of Diverging Streets: Trajectories of Urban Conflicts in Russia*. Monograph. Moscow; Saint Petersburg: Federal Center of Theoretical and Applied Sociology of the Russian Academy of Sciences.
- [9] Minaeva E., Panov P. (2020) Localization of Ethnic Groups in the Regions as a Factor of Cross-Regional Variations in Voting for United Russia. *Russian Politics*: 131-153.
- [10] Minaeva E., Semenov A. (2020) The Cities of Forking Streets: Trajectories of Urban Conflicts in Russia. *The Journal of Social Policy Studies*, Vol. 19, Issue 2: 189-204. *(in Russian)*
- [11] Minaeva E., Semenov A. (2020) Policy Transfer in Urban Governance: The Case of Strategic Urban Planning in Russia. *Ars Administrandi*, Vol. 1: 120-136. *(in Russian)*
- [12] Minaeva E., Panov. P. (2017) Ethnic Regional Autonomies: Variation of the Correlation Between Sub-State Boundaries and Ethnic Groups' Settlements. *Political Science*, Vol. 4: 178-205. *(in Russian)*
- [13] Minaeva E. (2016) Urban Settlement Versus Municipal District» in the Context of Vertical Power Structure: Polycentricity in Local Polity. *Bulletin of Perm University. Political Science*, Vol. 1: 83-96. *(in Russian)*

WORKING PAPERS *Solo-authored*

- [1] Minaeva E. Citizens' Perceptions of Local Government under Centralized Rule: A Survey Experiment in Russia.
- [2] Minaeva E. Why Autocrats (De)centralize Electoral Authority: Explaining the Introduction and Cancellation of Subnational Elections.

Co-authored

- [3] Minaeva E., Melnikov K., Hazell T. Local Elections and Elite Management in Authoritarian Regimes: Evidence from Kazakhstan.
- [4] Minaeva E., Melnikov K., Hazell T. The Governance Effects of Local Elections in Autocracies: Evidence from a Natural Experiment in Kazakhstan.

ONLINE PUBLICATIONS

- [1] Rogov K., & Minaeva E. (2022) The Journey from 1945 to 1941 [\[Link\]](#)
- [2] Minaeva E. (2018) GIS Technologies in Ethno-Political Studies: Spatial Localization of Ethnic Groups [\[Link\]](#)

RESEARCH
PROJECTS AND
COLLABORATIONS

Maidan Revolutions, the War in Ukraine, and Civil Society Responses [[Project link](#)]

- Design and implementation of cross-national survey research in **Armenia, Belarus, Russia, and Ukraine**, including questionnaire development, coordination with survey firms, and data analysis.

GLOBAL — European Governance and Politics Programme (ERC Advanced Grant) [[Project link](#)]

- Data collection and validation on transnational party networks; development of datasets for evaluating large language models (LLMs).

TEACHING
EXPERIENCE

Instructor, TU Darmstadt, Darmstadt, Germany Fall 2024; Fall 2025

- Political Paths of Post-Soviet Countries (MA level, block seminar)

Instructor, European University Institute, Florence, Italy 2023

- Introduction to R (PhD level)

Teaching Assistant, Perm State University, Perm, Russia 2020–2022

- Comparative Politics
- Methodology of Political Science
- R Programming
- Regional Studies

SKILLS AND
LANGUAGES

Methods:

- Causal inference with observational data (panel and cross-sectional)
- Quasi-experimental designs (including difference-in-differences)
- Survey and vignette experiments; questionnaire design
- Multilevel and regression analysis

Programming and Tools:

- R&R Studio (Advanced), STATA (Intermediate), Python (Beginner)
- L^AT_EX (Advanced), ArcGIS/ArcMap (Intermediate)
- Large language models (LLMs) for data collection and validation (Intermediate)

Languages:

- Russian: native
- English: advanced
- Italian: conversational (A2-B1)

ACADEMIC
LEADERSHIP AND
SERVICE

Researchers' Representative 2024–2025
Department of Political and Social Sciences, European University Institute

GRANTS

European University Institute — Early Stage Researchers Grant 2024–2025
Local Elections and Elite Management in Authoritarian Regimes: Evidence from Kazakhstan

[Russian Science Foundation](#) 2018–2023
Collective Grant
Mechanisms of Interests Coordination in the Urban Development Processes

	Oxford Russia Fellowship Individual Grant <i>Political Consequences of the Implementation of Municipal Heads' Appointments in Russia</i>	2020–2021
	Russian Foundation for Basic Research Collective Grant <i>Spatial Localization of Ethnic Minorities within the Framework of Political-Administrative Boundaries as a Factor of Politicization of Ethnicity on Sub-National Level: Russian Practices in the Context of World Experience</i>	2019–2021
	Volkswagen Foundation Collective Grant for Interdisciplinary and International Research <i>Shifting Paradigms: Towards Participatory and Effective Urban Planning in Germany, Russia and Ukraine</i>	2019–2021
	Russian Science Foundation Collective Grant for Russian Scholars <i>Securing a Balance in Interethnic Relations: Regional autonomies, the State Integrity and the Rights of Ethnic Minorities</i>	2015–2017
LATEST CONFERENCES AND WORKSHOP TALKS	Political Behaviour Colloquium, March 10, 2026 Paper: <i>Citizens' Perceptions of Local Government under Centralized Rule: A Survey Experiment in Russia</i> MPSA, Politics and Political Economy of Eurasia Workshop, April 23-26, 2025, Chicago Paper: <i>Local Elections and Elite Management: Evidence from Kazakhstan, co-authored with Kirill Melnikov and Thomas Hazell</i> The Russia Program Annual Conference, April 18, 2025, Washington DC Paper: <i>Russian Centralization in the Global Authoritarian Context</i> Pre-EPISA Conference on Authoritarian Politics, July 3, 2024, Cologne Paper: <i>Legitimacy Erosion and State Capacity: Explaining Political (De)Centralization in Dictatorships</i> Building Closed Autocracies: the Cases of Russia and Belarus, October 6-7, 2022, Berlin Paper: <i>Non-Programmatic Electoral Mobilization of Ethnic Minorities: Evidence from Russia</i> 5th Annual Tartu Conference on Russian and East European Studies, June 6-8, 2021 Paper: <i>From Elections to Appointments: Does Centralization Strengthen Political Support? Evidence from the Russian Municipalities</i> ASN Annual World Convention, May 6-8, 2021 Paper: <i>Political Consequences of the Implementation of Municipal Heads' Appointments in Russia</i> St. Petersburg Conference on Inequality and Diversity, October 21-22, 2019 Paper: <i>Machine Politics at the Local Level in Russia at the Present Stage</i> RC21 Delhi conference "In and Beyond the City: Emerging Ontologies, Persistent Challenges and Hopeful Futures", September 18-21, 2019 Paper: <i>Citizen-State Interactions in Urban Planning in Russian Cities</i>	